



Common Sense Reborn

Player Guide

Version 1.8.37 - Build 42 - No Dependencies

100+ features. One mod. Just common sense.

A polished, player-friendly feature guide for survival, combat, vehicles, inventory, crafting, world interaction, and multiplayer.

Workshop ID: 3698958906



Quick Start

Common Sense Reborn adds 100+ quality-of-life improvements to Project Zomboid. Most features are on by default and work the moment you load in - no setup required.

Try these first

- Right-click a locked door while holding a crowbar - Pry Open.
- Right-click a can of food while holding a knife - Open Can.
- Press Numpad + by default to toggle your seatbelt inside a vehicle.
- Open the world map and look for color-coded zombie density blobs.
- Right-click clothing in your inventory to tear, repair, wash, or rename items.
- Right-click a wardrobe to use Outfit Sets and save your current clothing as a preset.
- In multiplayer, use Utility HUD - Journal to save your skill levels.

Where settings live

Setting Type	Location
Keybinds	Main Menu - Mod Options - Common Sense Reborn
Server/gameplay feature toggles	Sandbox Options - CSR Tools, Combat, Gameplay, Vehicles, Interface, Server
Per-player preferences	In-game context menus or Utility HUD
Admin controls	In-game Utility HUD - Admin Tools

Tip: All major features have their own on/off sandbox switch. If something is not working, check the relevant Sandbox Options tab first.



Feature Overview

A condensed reference of the major feature groups. Detailed descriptions follow in later sections.

Feature	What It Does	Access	Type
Can & Jar Opening	Open cans with knife/screwdriver; jars return the jar.	Right-click food item	Player
Pry System	Crowbar-force locked doors, windows, garages, and vehicles.	Right-click door/vehicle	Player
Screwdriver Lockpick	Pick locks quietly with a screwdriver.	Right-click locked door	Player
Bolt Cutters	Cut padlocks and wire fences.	Right-click chain/fence	Player
Improvised Hotwire	Start vehicle without key skill requirement.	Vehicle context menu	Player
Repair Extensions	Repair items with duct tape, glue, or adhesive tape.	Right-click damaged item	Player
Outfit Sets	Save and load clothing presets from wardrobes.	Right-click wardrobe	Player
Home Canning	Preserve food in mason jars.	Crafting menu	Player
Loot Filter	Hide clutter in the loot panel.	Inventory panel toggle	Player
Proximity Loot	Grab matching items from nearby open containers.	Inventory panel button	Player
Eat All Stack	Eat an entire food stack in one action.	Right-click food - Eat menu	Player
Magazine Batch	Load/unload all magazines at once.	Right-click magazine	Player
Wash All	Wash all dirty items at a water source.	Right-click water source	Player
Item Rename	Give any item a custom name.	Right-click item	Player
Ground Marking	Spray arrows and symbols on the ground.	Right-click ground	Player
Notice Board	Write on world notice boards/whiteboards.	Right-click notice/whiteboard	Player
Hydration Sense	Auto-drink or reminder when dangerously thirsty.	Automatic	Player
Antibody System	Build immunity through survived infections.	Utility HUD - Antibody	Server
Infection Resilience	Chance to naturally fight off infection at high health.	Automatic	Server
Sleep Anywhere	Sleep on floors, chairs, and vehicle seats.	Context menu on surface	Player
Bathing	Full bath system in tubs/sinks.	Right-click tub/sink	Player
Rain Cleanse	Rain washes blood/dirt off character and gear.	Automatic outdoors	Server
Stop Drop & Roll	Extinguish flames by rolling on the ground.	Right-click while on fire	Player
Survivor Bond	Proximity mood buff when grouped with other players.	Automatic MP	Server
Knowledge Sharing	Teach recipes or give lectures to other players.	Right-click player MP	Server
Player Trading	Secure item trade window between two players.	Right-click player MP	Server
Skill Journal	Save/restore skill levels after death.	Utility HUD - Journal	Server
Server Rankings	Live leaderboard for kills, XP, and distance.	Rankings sidebar icon	Server
Player Map Tracking	See player positions on the map.	Map when enabled	Server
Safehouse Claims	Extended territory claim/protection system.	Claims Manager panel	Server
Rally Points	Share map waypoints with teammates.	Right-click world map MP	Server
Login Protection	Grace period after login before zombies can attack.	Automatic MP	Server
Seatbelt	80% crash damage reduction when buckled.	Numpad + default	Player
Vehicle Claim	Claim vehicles in multiplayer.	Vehicle radial menu	Server
Roof Climb	Climb onto vehicle roofs for height advantage.	Right-click vehicle	Player
Eat While Driving	Eat food while the vehicle is moving.	Right-click food in vehicle	Player





Feature	What It Does	Access	Type
EV Conversion	Convert vehicles to run on battery power.	Trunk context menu	Server
Power Bar	Extension cord to run power from generators.	Right-click generator	Player
City Standpipes	Use fire hydrants as water sources.	Right-click standpipe	Server
Bullet Penetration	Bullets pass through multiple zombies in a line.	Automatic	Server
Throwable Items	Throw bricks, bottles, and cans as weapons/distractions.	Right-click throwable	Player
Zombie Density Overlay	Color-coded zombie density heat map.	Map / hotkey	Player
Visual Sound Cues	On-screen directional indicators for nearby sounds.	Automatic	Player
Knox Syndicate	Call zombie-clearing support via radio.	Radio context menu	Server
Russian Roulette	Dangerous MP revolver mini-game.	Right-click revolver MP	Server
Field Dress	Harvest meat from corpses as last resort.	Right-click corpse	Server



Survival & Health

Hydration Sense

Watches your thirst level and steps in before dehydration becomes critical. In Auto-Drink mode it drinks the safest available water when thirst reaches a danger threshold. In Reminder mode it sends a text cue instead. It avoids dangerous liquids such as tainted water, bleach, alcohol, and fuel.

Settings: CSR Gameplay - EnableHydrationSense, HydrationSenseMode, DangerousThirst

Antibody System

Tracks a character antibody level from 0-100 that grows after surviving exposure to the Knox virus. Higher antibodies improve infection resistance rolls. Blood draw actions can create serum for other players.

Access: Utility HUD - Antibody.

Settings: CSR Gameplay - EnableAntibodySystem and Antibody options.

Infection Resilience

Gives infected characters a small random chance to naturally fight off infection at high health. Low-health characters gain minimal benefit. Failed upper-threshold rolls apply a health penalty.

Settings: CSR Gameplay - EnableInfectionResilience and InfRes options.

Bathing

Adds bathing at tubs, sinks, or large water containers. Removes blood, dirt, and body odor. Can automatically remove outer clothing before bathing.

Access: Right-click bathtub or sink with water - Bathe.

Rain Cleanse

Standing outside in rain or snow gradually washes blood and dirt from the character, exposed gear, nearby vehicle panels, and ground tiles.

Settings: CSR Gameplay - EnableRainCleanse, RainCleanseSpeedFactor.

Stop Drop & Roll

When on fire, right-click to roll and extinguish flames. This damages outer clothing layers. Lucky reduces clothing damage; Unlucky worsens it.

Settings: CSR Gameplay - EnableStopDropRoll.

Survivor Bond

In multiplayer, players near each other for sustained periods gain a proximity mood buff that reduces stress, boredom, fatigue, and unhappiness. A HUD icon shows active status.

Settings: CSR Server - EnableSurvivorBond and SurvivorBond options.

Inventory & Crafting

Can & Jar Opening

Open cans and preserve jars without a can opener by using a knife or screwdriver. Jars return the empty jar and lid. Bulk open actions are available from bags.

Warning: Screwdriver opening has a small hand-cut chance.

Outfit Sets



Save and restore clothing presets from wardrobes, lockers, or dressers. Supports up to 8 named slots and categories. The system finds the best-condition matching items across inventory and nearby wardrobe.

Access: Right-click wardrobe/locker/dresser - Outfit Sets.

Home Canning & Jar Capping

Seal cooked food in jars for long-term storage and preserve foods through crafting recipes.

Access: Right-click filled jar - Cap Jar; home canning recipes appear in Crafting.

Loot Filter

Adds inventory/loot panel toggles to hide clutter categories and focus on useful items. Preferences save locally.

Access: Open a container and use CSR filter buttons.

Proximity Loot Helper

When a container is open, quickly pull matching items from other open nearby containers into the selected one.

Access: Inventory panel CSR Proximity Loot button.

Other inventory conveniences

Includes Nested Containers, Loot Bag, Eat All Stack, Magazine Batch Actions, Wash All, Material Bundles, Tool Set, Item Rename, Dismantle All Watches, Binks Scooper, and Rodent Cuisine.



Entry, Tools & World

Pry System

Use a crowbar to force open locked doors, windows, garages, reinforced doors, and vehicle doors/hatches.

Success scales with Strength. Prying makes noise and can attract zombies.

Access: Right-click target with crowbar - Pry Open.

Screwdriver Lockpick

Pick locks quietly with a screwdriver. Success depends on Nimble and Mechanics skills.

Access: Right-click locked door or vehicle - Pick Lock.

Bolt Cutters

Cut padlocks and wire fences to breach chain-link fences or remove padlocked gates.

Access: Right-click padlock/fence - Cut.

Improvised Hotwire & Un-Hotwire

Start a vehicle without a key using screwdriver and pliers, then optionally restore key-start behavior with Un-Hotwire.

Access: Vehicle context menu.

City Standpipes

Use fire hydrants as water sources with a pipe wrench and minimum Strength. Opening valves takes time and causes muscle strain. State persists between server restarts.

Ground Marking

Spray arrows and survival symbols on the ground. Spray paint is permanent; crayon marks degrade in rain.

Access: Right-click ground - Mark Ground.

Other world utilities

Includes Repair Extensions, Tear All Clothing, Field Filters, Lighter Refill, Battery Replacement, Flashlight Attachments, Ladder Climb, Climb With Bags, Bag Bottom Attachments, Sweep Trash, Corpse Ignite, Useful Barrels, Fireworks, Notice Boards, Clipboard, Fridge Toggle, and Perfume as Disinfectant.

Combat & Weapons

Bullet Penetration

Bullets can pass through multiple zombies in a line with reduced damage on later targets. Modes and target counts are configurable.

Throwable Items

Throw bricks, bottles, canned food, and other improvised items as weapons or distractions. Damage, noise, and break chance are configurable.

Dual Wield

Off by default. Equip a weapon in the off-hand and attack with both hands independently. Test before enabling because it changes combat balance.

Fire Trail





Characters who are on fire can leave burning tiles behind as they move. Can be restricted by server settings.

Knox Syndicate

Off by default. Radio-based support run that clears zombies around the caller. Has cooldowns and can be admin-restricted.

Russian Roulette Session

Multiplayer risk feature. Server-side revolver mini-game. Real character death option is off by default.

Other combat utilities

Includes Point Blank, Gear Sling, Reload All Magazines, Speed Reload, Seated Reload Bonus, and Cone Vision Outline.



Vehicles

Seatbelt

Toggle seatbelt to reduce crash damage by 80%. A small indicator and Utility HUD show buckle status.

Hotkey: Numpad + by default, rebindable in Mod Options.

Vehicle Claim

Claim vehicles in multiplayer to prevent unauthorized use. Violations can trigger configurable punishments.

Access: Vehicle radial menu; manage through Claims Manager.

Roof Climb

Climb onto vehicle roofs for height advantage and better visibility. Requires a Strength check and fall damage may apply.

Power Bar

Run power from generators through a cable to appliances or devices up to a configurable distance. Optional overload fire chance.

EV Conversion

Off by default. Convert gas vehicles to electric using batteries, wiring, duct tape, and charger setup. Requires Mechanics/Electrical skill.

Other vehicle features

Includes Eat While Driving, Dashboard Highlights, Vehicle Mechanics QoL, Vehicle Salvage, Corpse in Trunk, Trunk Spillage, Tow Assist, Rope Tow, Generator Info HUD, Vehicle Clock/HVAC, Radio Quick Toggle, Cabin Filter, Vehicle Craft Surfaces, Weather Exposure, and RV Exit Rescue.

HUD & Interface

Utility HUD

Draggable floating panel for core CSR controls: seatbelt, pry status, player map tracking, zombie density, standpipe status, Skill Journal, Antibody, and admin tools.

Zombie Density Overlay

Color-coded world-map heat map showing zombie concentration. Green means clear/light, amber means moderate, red means heavy, and purple means extreme.

Hotkey: Numpad * by default.

Visual Sound Cues

Subtle directional indicators for nearby world sounds such as breaking glass, gunshots, alarms, and screams.

Character Info Enhancements

Adds compact nutrition summary to the character info panel, including weight trend, calories, protein, carbs, and fats.

Other interface features





Includes Weapon HUD Overlay, Offhand Overlay, Mask HUD, Status Bar, Equipment Panel, Stair Sense, Vault Guard, Back to Slot, Item Insight Tooltips, Quick Sit, Quick Device Toggle, TV Radial Menu, Video Insert, Room Scanner, Survivor Ledger, Smart Vehicle Key Labels, Animated Duffle Bags, Hide Version Watermark, Colored Toggles, and CSR Radial Menu.



Multiplayer Systems

Skill Journal

Save a snapshot of skills on the server. After death, recover a configurable portion of saved skills. Cooldowns and profession locks can apply.

Access: Utility HUD - Journal.

Server Rankings

Leaderboard for zombie kills, XP, distance traveled, and optional PvP kills. Data retention is configurable.

Knowledge Sharing

High-skill players can teach recipes or give XP lectures to nearby players.

Access: Right-click nearby player - Teach Recipe or Start Lecture.

Safehouse & Territory Claims

Extended claim system with territory expansion, member roles, container protection, padlocks, optional raid windows, faction-linked claims, and claim respawn.

Login Protection

On joining a multiplayer server, players receive a grace period before nearby zombies can attack. Aggressive action ends protection early.

Player Map Tracking

Shows other players on the world map based on server visibility rules: faction-only, group-only, or all players.

Rally Points

Create and share map waypoints with teammates. Received rally points pulse and auto-clear when reached.

Other MP features

Includes Player Trading, Faction Extensions, Survivor Bond, Ground Cleanup, Item Wipe Scheduler, Admin Safehouse Release, and Admin Authoritative Control.



Controls & Settings Reference

Default Hotkeys

Action	Default Key	How to Rebind
Toggle Seatbelt	Numpad +	Mod Options - CSR - seatbeltToggle
Toggle Zombie Density Overlay	Numpad *	Mod Options - CSR Density - densityToggle

Sandbox Option Pages

Sandbox Tab	Main Contents
CSR Tools	Entry systems, repair, cans, jars, clothing, containers, standpipes, fireworks, filters, barrels.
CSR Combat	Dual wield, bullet penetration, point blank, throwables, cone vision, weapon HUD, fire trail, speed reload, gear sling, reload mags.
CSR Gameplay	Sleep, bathing, hydration, infection, antibodies, lighters, batteries, rain cleanse, rodent cuisine, power systems, outfit sets, EV, Knox Syndicate, roulette, field dress.
CSR Vehicles	Seatbelt, eat while driving, dashboard, mechanics QoL, salvage, vehicle claim, towing, generator, roof climb, weather, craft surfaces, trunk spillage, rope tow, cabin filter.
CSR Interface	HUD panels, loot filter, proximity loot, sound cues, tooltips, zombie density, room scanner, notice board, clipboard, wash all, eat all, mag batch, device toggle, ground cleanup, quick sit, animated duffles.
CSR Server	Player map, knowledge sharing, massage, claims, vehicle claim enforcement, rankings, skill journal, faction extensions, rally points, login protection, survivor bond, RV rescue.



Key Context Menu Locations

Target	Common Options
Door / Window	Pry Open, Pick Lock
Vehicle outside	Claim, Roof Climb, Tow, Rope Tow
Vehicle inside, driver	Hotwire, Un-Hotwire, Eat While Driving
Clothing / item	Tear, Repair, Wash, Rename
Can / Jar	Open Can / Open Jar, Open All
Food	Eat All Stack
Player MP	Trade, Teach Recipe, Start Lecture, Massage
Wardrobe / Locker	Outfit Sets - Save / Wear / Delete
Ground	Mark Ground, Sweep Trash, Sweep Ashes
Water source	Wash All, Bathe
Corpse	Ignite, Field Dress if enabled, Load into Trunk
Standpipe	Open Valve - pipe wrench required
Radio	Knox Syndicate Call if enabled, Quick Toggle
Revolver MP	Start Roulette Session



Multiplayer Notes

For Players

- Most features work identically in singleplayer and multiplayer.
- Skill Journal: save regularly - you cannot save on demand right before death.
- Vehicle Claim: respect claimed vehicles; server-configurable consequences may apply.
- Login Protection: you have a short login window before zombies can target you.
- Survivor Bond: stay near teammates for gradual mood improvements.
- Player Map: other players appear only if the server has tracking enabled.

For Admins & Server Owners

- Configure Sandbox Options before inviting players.
- Review claim raid windows, container protection, and claim expansion settings before going live.
- Ground Cleanup is off by default; enable only if clutter causes performance issues.
- SkillJournalAdminOnlyRecover allows admin review before recovery.
- Set VehicleClaimPunishmentTier to 0 to disable violation punishments.
- Knox Syndicate, Dual Wield, and EV Conversion are off by default - test before enabling.
- Trunk Spillage, Vehicle Weather, and Field Dress are optional immersion/difficulty features.
- Rankings data retention is controlled by RankingsRetentionDays.



Mods This May Replace

Common Sense Reborn covers a wide range of quality-of-life features. If you used separate Workshop mods for similar functions, you may no longer need them. Always test on your own server - compatibility is not guaranteed.

Fair-use note: This guide does not claim CSR is a perfect replacement for any listed type of mod. Some mods may include extra features not covered by CSR. Do not run overlapping features together without testing.

Workshop Mod Type	What It Does	CSR Feature	Level	B42 Status
Crowbar Pry mods	Pry locked doors with a crowbar	Pry System	Full	Likely replaced
Lockpicking mods	Screwdriver / pick lockpicking	Screwdriver Lockpick	Full	Likely replaced
Seatbelt mods	Crash damage reduction	Seatbelt System	Full	Likely replaced
Eat While Driving	Eat food in moving vehicles	Eat While Driving	Full	Likely replaced
Bulk Ammo Load mods	Load all magazines at once	Magazine Batch Actions	Full	Likely replaced
Bulk Cloth Tear mods	Tear multiple clothing items	Tear All Clothing	Full	Likely replaced
Item Rename mods	Custom item names	Item Rename	Full	Likely replaced
Zombie Density Map mods	Map overlay for zombie density	Zombie Density Overlay	Full	Likely replaced
Player Map Marker mods	Player positions on map	Player Map Tracking	Full	Likely replaced
Sleep Anywhere mods	Sleep on non-bed surfaces	Sleep Anywhere	Full	Likely replaced
Notice Board mods	Writable in-world notes	Notice Board	Full overlap	Likely replaced
Ground Cleanup mods	Auto-remove old ground items	Ground Cleanup	Full	Likely replaced
Loot Filter mods	Filter inventory by category	Loot Filter	Full overlap	Check Workshop
Home Canning / Expanded Foods	Food preservation in jars	Home Canning, Jar Capping	Partial overlap	Compatibility unclear
Group Buff mods	Mood buffs near teammates	Survivor Bond	Full overlap	Check Workshop
Antibody / Immunity mods	Earned immunity system	Antibody System	Full	Check Workshop



Troubleshooting

A feature is not showing up

- Check Sandbox Options - most features have an Enable* toggle.
- Some features are multiplayer-only or require a server.
- If you joined someone else's server, the admin controls what is enabled.
- If you added the mod mid-game, a full restart may be needed.

A right-click option is greyed out or missing

- Check required tools in hand or inventory.
- Check skill requirements such as Strength for prying.
- Confirm the feature is enabled in Sandbox Options.
- Step closer; some options only appear at close range.

Seatbelt key does not respond

- Main Menu - Mod Options - Common Sense Reborn - check seatbeltToggle.
- Default is Numpad +. Rebind it if your keyboard lacks a numpad.
- Check for conflicts with other mods or vanilla keybinds.

Zombie Density Overlay not showing

- Confirm EnableZombieDensityOverlay is enabled.
- Press the density toggle hotkey; the overlay can be toggled off.
- Use the world map, not a paper map item.

Claims / safehouses not working

- Confirm EnableCSRClaimsOverride is true.
- Check MaxSafehouseClaims.
- Admins can use Admin Safehouse Release to clear abandoned claims.
- If players are blocked from their own claim, check role settings.

Skill Journal shows no data after death

- Journal only saves if you clicked Save before dying.
- Cooldowns apply between saves.
- If admin approval is enabled, recovery requires admin action.

Features conflict with another mod

- Features that override vanilla menus can conflict with other menu mods.
- Disable the overlapping CSR feature if another mod handles it better.
- Report persistent conflicts with a full mod list.



Final Notes & Recommended Setup

For New Servers

- Configure Sandbox Options before inviting players.
- Enable Skill Journal and Rankings for persistence and community engagement.
- Leave Knox Syndicate, EV Conversion, and Dual Wield off until your server balance is tested.
- Set safehouse and vehicle claim limits appropriate for your player count.
- Leave Ground Cleanup off unless server clutter becomes a real performance issue.
- Test pry noise settings against your preferred difficulty.

For Singleplayer

- Defaults are balanced enough to start playing without changing settings.
- Enable the Antibody System if you want a more involved infection-resistance arc.
- EV Conversion adds a late-game vehicle project.
- Field Dress is off by default; enable only if you want that extra survival challenge.

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All settings can be changed in Sandbox Options. Some changes may require a full server restart to take effect cleanly.